

Once you give away your code, who will want to pay?

CollabCAD already has distributors in India to provide marketing, support and training services. Open sourcing will increase visibility and open up a larger market for distributors. In addition, open source giants including Red Hat and Magento offer a variety of certification options. This is another untapped revenue opportunity for CollabCAD. The e-book can also be sold to a much larger audience base. There will always be a group of users who will download the community version and depend wholly on community support. But they will also contribute to the product's strength by actively providing user-to-user support and generating valuable feature suggestions. However, serious businesses will be glad to pay because they will need the peace of mind that comes only with assured support.

MySQL has a dual licensing model, which is a good fit for a product that needs to be embedded in

other proprietary licensed products. However, this is not a suitable model for a product like CollabCAD. When Magento Commerce (on-premises) was introduced, it had the same core source as the Magento Community Edition but was designed for large businesses that require technical support for installation, usage, configuration and troubleshooting. This is a more appropriate model to consider for CollabCAD.

Won't NIC lose control by open sourcing?

NIC will still retain control by owning the brand as well as keeping commit rights to the code base within its own core team. This way it can harness the energy of the very large developer pool to maintain and improve the code as

well as support users. In addition, NIC will, of course, continue to own the official documentation and certification programs as well as control the support ecosystem of distributors, training and other partners.

Open sourcing will make CollabCAD a world leader

When Adobe acquired the company that developed the mobile application development framework PhoneGap, the CEO of the company said this about why it open sourced it, "You'll be blown away by how much better your code gets and how much more quickly you can reach a broader audience." So if reaching a broader audience is the name of the game, open sourcing is the best way to play it! **END** 

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